Conversation to Client Conversion Kit

A step by step guide to the
5 to 7 minute networking conversation

Build your message. Understand what matters. Book the next conversation.

You have just met someone at a virtual networking event, in a networking group, or at an event in person. You have five to seven minutes together. This workbook teaches you how to introduce what you do, uncover a result and its deeper benefit, and invite a relevant next conversation.

Your immediate goal is a booked 15–30 minute qualification or good-fit call when both people want to explore further. A booking means there is enough shared interest to continue. It does not yet mean the person is qualified or ready to buy.

The path you are practicing

Stage	Purpose
5–7 minute networking conversation	Connect, understand the desired result and benefit, and earn a booked qualification call.
15–30 minute qualification call	A later guide will cover mutual fit and whether the prospect is ready, willing, and able.
Discovery and later sales stages	We will develop the 60-minute discovery call, presentation, and close separately.

Use this kit in three passes

Prepare your message with pages 2–3. Learn and rehearse the conversation with pages 4–7. Complete the opener practice, role-play review, and live call notes on pages 8–10.

The short conversation should feel useful to both people. Ask one question at a time, listen to the answer, and leave room for the other person to speak. A respectful ending is also a good outcome when there is no interest in continuing.

Build your audio business card

An audio business card is a short spoken introduction. It tells someone who you work with, what changes for that person, and why the change matters. You do not need an audio file or a printed card to use it.

The formula

I [action verb] [specific people] to [specific result] so they can [specific benefit].

Choose a verb that describes your work honestly: coach, guide, teach, equip, support, train, or another action that fits. Adjust the connecting words so the sentence sounds natural. Keep one audience, one result, and one benefit in each version.

Part	What to write
Action verb	What do you do for or with someone? Use an ordinary verb, not a job title.
Specific people	Who can recognize themselves in your message? Narrow “everyone” to a real group.
Result	What observable change do you support? Make it more concrete than “success.”
Benefit	What does that change make possible? Explain why the result matters to that person.

An original example

> “I coach newly promoted managers to delegate clearly so they can stop carrying every team decision themselves.”

Result: clearer delegation. Benefit: less dependence on the manager for every decision. This is an illustrative example; write your own version for your business.

Build your first version

My action verb and specific people

The result they want

What that result makes possible

My full spoken introduction

Say it aloud. Aim for one comfortable breath or roughly 10–20 seconds. Remove jargon and any claim you cannot support. Ask a practice partner to repeat what you do; revise anything they cannot explain.

Create and test ten versions

Write ten distinct target markets, ten results, and ten benefits. Use the rows below to form ten believable combinations. Match each result to the people who want it and each benefit to the result that would create it.

No	Specific people	Result	Benefit
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			

Turn the combinations into spoken sentences

For each row, write or say: “I [action verb] [specific people] to [result] so they can [benefit].” Vary the action verb when it improves the meaning. Do not combine all ten messages into one introduction.

Choose your strongest version for the event you are attending. Prepare one alternative for a different audience. Your prepared benefit is a starting hypothesis; during the conversation, discover what actually matters to this person.

Expand your message practice

For more practice, choose ten message themes and make a copy of this page for each theme. Develop ten target markets, ten results, and ten benefits within each. Keep the combinations relevant instead of swapping words at random.

Circle the version you will practice first. Write its complete sentence on page 2.

Use the five step conversation framework

Follow the same sequence as the live role-play: connect briefly, find the result, find the deeper benefit, reflect their words, and invite the next conversation. The time windows below are practice guides. Follow the person's answers rather than a stopwatch script.

Step	5 minute version	7 minute version
1 Connect briefly	0:00–0:45	0:00–1:00
2 Find the result	0:45–2:00	1:00–3:00
3 Find the deeper benefit	2:00–3:00	3:00–4:30
4 Reflect their words	3:00–3:30	4:30–5:00
5 Invite and book	3:30–5:00	5:00–7:00

Step 1 Connect briefly

"Good to meet you. What kind of work do you do, and who do you usually work with?"

Listen and respond to something they actually said. When they ask about you, use your audio business card once, then make room for them. If you go first, give your short introduction and ask about their work.

Move from your introduction to their interest

If they ask "How do you do that?" give a brief, truthful answer, then ask what prompted the question. A natural transition is:

"I have a process for that. What made you ask?"

Use that wording only if you have a process. You can be more specific: "I work with managers on delegation habits. What made you ask?" The transition should open a conversation, not evade a reasonable question about your work.

Make the setting work for you

On a virtual networking event or another timed round, keep the introduction short and leave time to agree on a next step before the round ends. In a networking group, share the airtime. In person, ask permission before showing a booking link or scanning a code. Keep your calendar and contact details easy to reach in every setting.

Find the result and the deeper benefit

Step 2 Find the result

"What would you most like to improve in that area right now?"

Listen for a specific change. If the answer is broad, ask one follow-up: "What would that look like in practice?" or "Which part matters most right now?" You need enough understanding to make the next conversation relevant; save detailed investigation for later.

For example, "I need a stronger team" might become "I want team members to handle routine decisions without waiting for me." Use the person's answer rather than selecting a problem you would prefer to sell against.

Step 3 Find the deeper benefit

"If you achieved that, what would it make possible for you or your business?"

A result is what changes. A benefit is why the change matters. Listen for the reason behind the desired improvement: more time, less rework, a better customer experience, room to grow, or another benefit they name.

If the answer remains vague, try: "What would be different in your day?" Give them time to think. You do not need to force a personal disclosure or manufacture urgency.

Step 4 Reflect their words

"It sounds like you want [their result], so you can [their benefit]. Did I understand that correctly?"

Pause for the answer. If they correct you, use the correction. If they mention several goals, ask which one deserves attention first. The invitation should connect to one confirmed result and one confirmed benefit.

Write what you heard

The result in their words

The benefit in their words

My one sentence reflection

If you cannot describe a relevant result and benefit yet, ask one useful clarification. Interest in your title, product, or technique alone is not a reason to assume they want a sales conversation.

Invite and book the qualification call

Step 5 Ask permission to continue

When their goal connects to work you can plausibly support, use one opener. You do not need to use all five opener styles in a conversation.

> "Would it make sense to explore some ways to [their result]?"

If they say yes, make the next step specific. Invite them to a 15–30 minute qualification or good-fit call before considering a longer discovery session.

Your invitation

> "Based on what you shared, would you be open to a 15–30 minute qualification or good-fit call? We can explore what you need to [result], so you can [benefit], and see whether working together makes sense for both of us."

Use the duration you actually offer when booking: "15-minute" or "30-minute." Keep the purpose clear. If the call is complimentary, you may say so; do not imply it is free unless that is true.

Turn agreement into a meeting

1. Stop adding selling points when they agree. Ask: "Great. Shall we find a time now?"

2. Offer real availability or open your booking link. Confirm the selected day, time, time zone, and call length.

3. Confirm the best email address and send the calendar invitation or complete the booking together. Include the meeting link or location and a brief purpose tied to their result.

4. Check that they received the invitation. Record the result, benefit, and any relevant context so the next conversation starts where this one ended.

If the networking round ends first

> "We're nearly out of time. Would you like me to send the link for that good-fit call? What is the best way to reach you?"

Agree on when they will choose a time. A sent link or exchanged business card is a follow-up action, not a booked call. Count it as booked only when a specific time is confirmed.

A simple calendar description

Purpose: Explore [result] and why [benefit] matters; determine whether a further conversation makes sense for both of us.
Duration: [15 or 30 minutes] | When: [date, time, time zone]
Where: [meeting link or location]

Rehearse a complete networking conversation

This fictional example shows the flow. Notice that the invitation follows what the other person says. Use your own words and let your partner supply their own answers when you practice.

Connect and introduce your work

You: “Good to meet you. What kind of work do you do?”
Other person: “I run a small design studio. We’ve recently grown the team.”
You: “That sounds like a busy transition. I coach newly promoted managers to delegate clearly so they can stop carrying every team decision themselves.”

Explore the interest

Other person: “How do you do that?”
You: “We work on delegation habits and clear decision responsibilities. What made you ask?”
Other person: “My team still asks me to approve almost everything.”

Find the result

You: “What would you most like to change about that?”
Other person: “I’d like them to make routine project decisions without waiting for me.”

Find the benefit

You: “If that happened, what would it make possible for you?”
Other person: “I could focus on our larger clients instead of answering questions all day.”

Reflect and get agreement

You: “So you want the team to handle routine decisions, so you can give your larger clients more attention. Did I get that right?”
Other person: “Exactly.”

Invite and book

You: “Would it make sense to explore some ways to improve that?”
Other person: “Yes.”
You: “Would you be open to a 15-minute good-fit call? We can explore the delegation issue and see whether working together could help you give those clients more attention.”
Other person: “Sure.”
You: “Great. Let’s find a time.”

Open your calendar or booking page. Agree on the actual time, confirm the time zone and email, and verify that the invitation arrived. The script ends with a confirmed next conversation, not a claim that the person is already qualified.

Write and practice twenty five openers

Choose one result your audience wants. Complete five versions of each opener below, using different relevant results. Use the wording that sounds most natural to you.

An opener tests interest in exploring the result. After agreement, use the qualification-call invitation on page 6. If your invitation already asks permission clearly, you can combine the opener and invitation into one natural question.

Openers 1 to 5

Are you open to learning some ways to [result]?

1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____
5. _____

Openers 6 to 10

Have you ever considered learning some ways to [result]?

1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____
5. _____

Openers 11 to 15

Do you keep your options open to learning some ways to [result]?

1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____
5. _____

Openers 16 to 20

Do you think it would make sense to learn some ways to [result]?

1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____
5. _____

Openers 21 to 25

Do you think it would help to learn some ways to [result]?

1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____
5. _____

Write the result phrases above, then say each complete question aloud. Replace awkward wording with plain language while keeping its purpose: permission to explore a relevant outcome. Circle your best three and practice them with a partner.

Practice with a partner and review

Use the same setup as the presentation: two people have just met at a networking event. Set a timer for five minutes, then repeat with seven. One person leads the conversation; the other uses a real or fictional business. Switch roles.

Run three rounds

Round 1: The other person has a relevant goal and wants to continue. Practice every step, including choosing a time.
Round 2: The person is curious but the result is unclear. Practice listening and one clarification before deciding whether an invitation is useful.
Round 3: The person has no interest or no relevant need. Practice a warm ending without forcing a meeting.

Review what actually happened

Check	Yes or not yet
My introduction named an action, specific people, a result, and a benefit.	
I kept my introduction brief and gave the other person room to speak.	
I learned a result in their words instead of assuming it.	
I asked what the result would make possible.	
I reflected the result and benefit and checked my understanding.	
My invitation explained the purpose and length of the next call.	
I confirmed a time or recorded an agreed follow-up action.	
I respected hesitation or a no without pressuring the person.	

If they do not want to book

“Not now”: “Would you prefer that I leave it here, or reconnect at a time you choose?”
“Send information”: “Of course. What would be most useful?” Agree on the item and delivery method; ask whether a follow-up is welcome.
“No thanks”: “No problem. It was good to meet you.”
No relevant need: Stay curious about their work. A useful relationship does not have to become a sales opportunity.

Improve one thing at a time

With permission, record a practice session or review your notes. Ask your partner what felt clear, rushed, or unnatural. Choose one improvement for the next round. Practice the framework until you can follow it while paying attention to the person.

The one change I will make next

Keep this beside your next conversation

Goal: Earn a booked 15–30 minute qualification or good-fit call when there is a relevant reason and mutual interest.

Move	Your cue
Connect	Ask about their work. Share your short audio business card when appropriate.
Find the result	What would you most like to improve?
Find the benefit	If you achieved that, what would it make possible?
Reflect	You want [result] so you can [benefit]. Did I get that right?
Invite and book	Would a [15 or 30]-minute good-fit call make sense? Agree on a time and confirm the invitation.

Conversation record

Name and business **Event or setting** **Date**

Their desired result and benefit

Outcome **Booked call / Agreed follow up / No next step**

Confirmed date time and time zone or agreed follow up action

What I will remember for the next conversation

Your practice routine

Say your introduction, one opener, and your invitation aloud before an event. After each conversation, complete the short record above. Track conversations, confirmed bookings, and pending follow-ups separately. Review what you learned before the next event; there is no promised conversion rate.

What comes next

This kit ends when the qualification call is booked or another next step is agreed. The qualification call, 60-minute discovery call, presentation, and close will each need their own preparation and practice. Do not treat a networking booking as proof of budget, readiness, or fit.

Spend your sales time with the right prospects

You have learned how to earn the next conversation. Now make that conversation count.

A booked meeting is a promising start. The next challenge is deciding whether the person belongs on a deeper sales call. A clear 15–30 minute qualification process can help you recognize a good fit, identify what is missing, and step back when the opportunity is wrong for either of you.

Book a 15 minute intro with Vlad

Bring one prospect you are unsure about, or one recent call that went nowhere. In a 15-minute intro, we can talk about where your conversations get stuck and how I can help you develop a qualification process for your business.

Find out how I can help you

- Clarify what makes someone the right prospect for your offer.
- Explore whether they have a relevant problem and are ready, willing, and able to act.
- Check whether their budget, requirements, and expectations align with what you can deliver.
- Decide when to invite a 60-minute discovery sales call, follow up later, or respectfully move on.

The intro is a chance to discuss your situation and whether working together makes sense. We will focus on the next step toward a stronger qualification process for you.

Give your next sales call a better starting point

Before you spend another hour exploring the wrong opportunity, let’s talk about how to recognize the right one sooner.

Book your 15-minute intro with Vlad

Click the link above to choose a time.

Vlad Gutenmakher
AI Consultant and Value Architect
Set Up Shop Online, Inc.